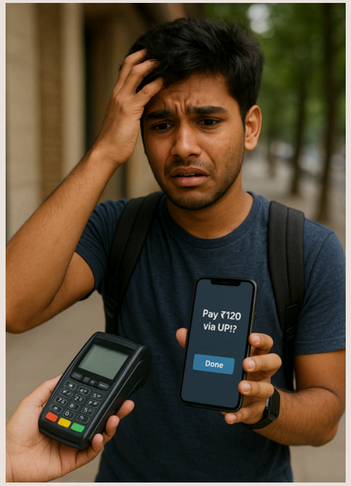
SPENDWISE

Because every rupee deserves awareness

The Invisible Money Problem of the UPI Generation

Meet Aarav, 22 —
pays for coffee, cabs, and recharges with a tap.
No cash, no pause — just “Pay ₹120 via UPI?” → Done.
By month-end, his account whispers: “Where did it all go?”



The Reality:

- India crosses 13.9 B UPI transactions/month (NPCI 2025)
- 85 % of Gen Z use UPI daily, yet 73 % don’t track spends (ET Money, 2025)
- 1 in 3 young earners face “month-end money anxiety”

Problem Space:

Digital payments made spending effortless,
but they also made money invisible — and awareness disappear.
Existing finance apps are too complex, built for investors, not everyday spenders.

Our Assumption:

If we design a simple, non-judgy, goal-driven app that visualizes spends, sets weekly targets, and rewards smart saving,
young users will spend wiser — and save smarter.

Our Vision:

👉 Bring money awareness back.
Make Gen Z see where their money goes — and feel in control again.

Opportunity:

- 110 M+ UPI-active Gen Z users in India
- Massive white space between “boring budget apps” and “real-time money mindfulness.”

Spendwise steps right into that gap.

Current Market Landscape — The Fintech Boom, Missing Awareness

India's fintech is exploding — UPI, neobanks, and digital wallets have made spending effortless. But in this rush to make payments instant, no one made awareness instant.

Investment & Wealth Apps
Players: CRED | Groww | Jupiter | Fi Money

They offer: Rewards, savings accounts, investment dashboards
Gap: Built for financially literate users

Expense Trackers
Players: Walnut | Money Manager | Monefy

They offer: Manual expense entry, category charts
Gap: Tedious, dated UIs → low daily engagement.

Bank & UPI Apps
Players: GPay | Paytm | PhonePe

They offer: Instant, seamless payments
Gap: Optimize for spending, not spend awareness.

Paytm

CRED

G Pay

Groww

💡 ***The Market Gap***

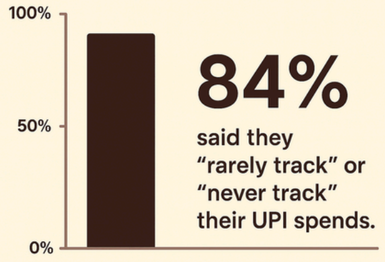
All these apps make transactions, tracking, or investing easier — but none make daily money awareness simple, visual, or habit-forming.

Spendwise = the missing layer — a friendly, Gen Z-first tool that turns invisible spends into visible habits.

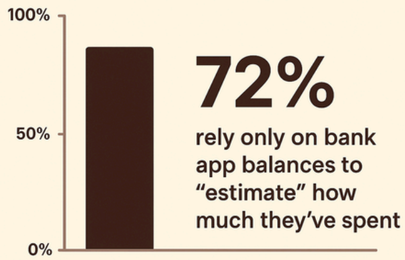
Understanding Our Users: Data + Voices + Personas

User Research

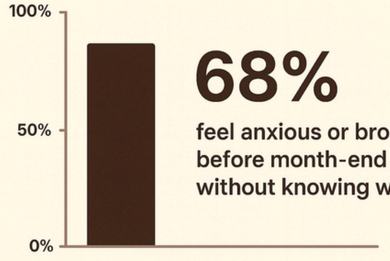
We spoke to 35 young users (ages 18–26) — a mix of college students, interns, and early professionals — to uncover how they manage daily spending in a UPI-first world



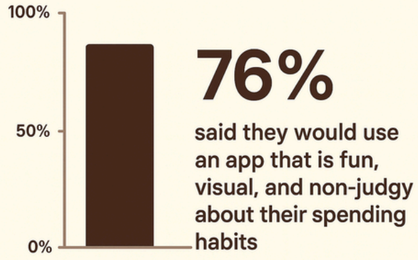
84%
said they "rarely track" or "never track" their UPI spends.



72%
rely only on bank app balances to "estimate" how much they've spent



68%
feel anxious or broke before month-end without knowing why



76%
said they would use an app that is fun, visual, and non-judgy about their spending habits

Interview Insights

People aren't afraid of money management — they're just overwhelmed by boring finance tools. They want awareness, not accounting.

- Uses UPI 8–10 times/day
- Pocket money + small freelance income.
- Problem: No tracking; broke before month-end
- Need: Visual, simple awareness of weekly spends
- Goal: Build saving habits without feeling restricted

RIYA SHARMA, 21
Final-year college student

ARJUN MEHTA, 24
Early-career professional, first job

- Spends impulsively on food, subscriptions, and weekend outings
- Pain: Feels "in control" only on salary day
- Need: Smart nudges when crossing limits
- Goal: Build discipline & plan small goals (gadgets, trips)

Problem Canvas : The Spending Blindspot of the UPI Generation

True Problem:

Young earners spend 10–15 times a day via UPI but have no visibility of where their money goes.
Finance apps feel complex, boring, or built for investors — not everyday Gen Z spenders.
It's not lack of money, it's lack of money awareness.

Who Faces It:

- Primary Segment: 18–23 yr college students & interns with limited income, high UPI usage, low tracking habits.
- Secondary Segment: 23–26 yr young professionals (early jobs) seeking control and small savings goals.

Why It's Real (Research Insights):

- 84 % rarely track spends or rely on bank balance guesswork.
- 68 % feel broke before month-end without knowing why.

Value Generated:

👤 For Users → Money awareness without guilt + smart saving wins.
💼 For Business → High-frequency fintech use case → gateway to micro-savings & brand partnerships.

Market Opportunity:

~150 M Gen Z (18–23 yrs) → 110 M UPI-active → ≈ 60 M students & early earners.
25 % face money awareness gap = 15 M TAM → 5 % early adoption ≈ 0.75 M potential MVP users.

Why Now 💡

UPI = instant spending , but zero reflection 😘.
Gen Z is earning digitally for the first time → needs habits, not graphs.
No player owns "money mindfulness" in India → Spendwise's moment is now.

From Ideas to MVP: Prioritizing What Matters

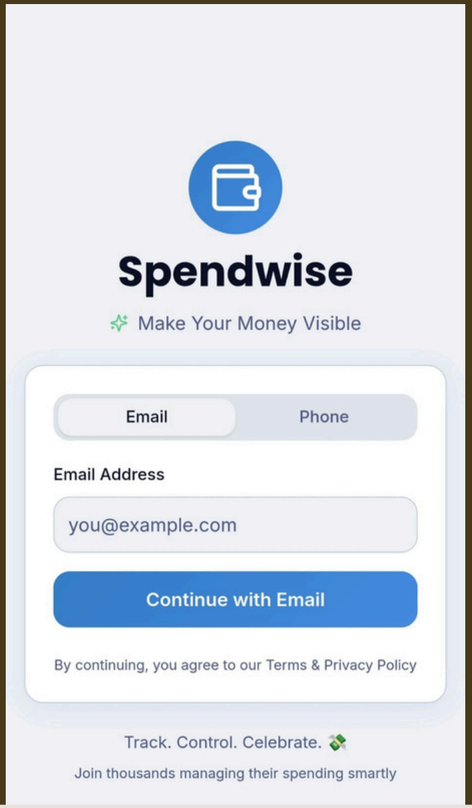
Feature Brainstorm

- UPI Spend Tracker — Auto-logs or manually records every UPI/payment spend in real time.
- Weekly/Monthly Target Setter — Users define soft limits (₹ or category-wise) and track progress visually.
- Smart Spend Dashboard — Simple insights on where money goes; top 3 spend categories.
- Nudge & Alert System — Friendly reminders when nearing or crossing weekly limits ("You're 80% through your goal 👀").
- Smart Save Wallet / Reward Goal — Rewards users who stay under budget; builds a wishlist-style fund.
- Social Save Challenge — Join friends in fun saving or "No-Spend Day" challenges.
- AI Advisory Coach — Suggests small behavioral tweaks like "Cut 10% on cabs = ₹300 saved weekly."

Prioritization (Impact × Confidence)/Effort

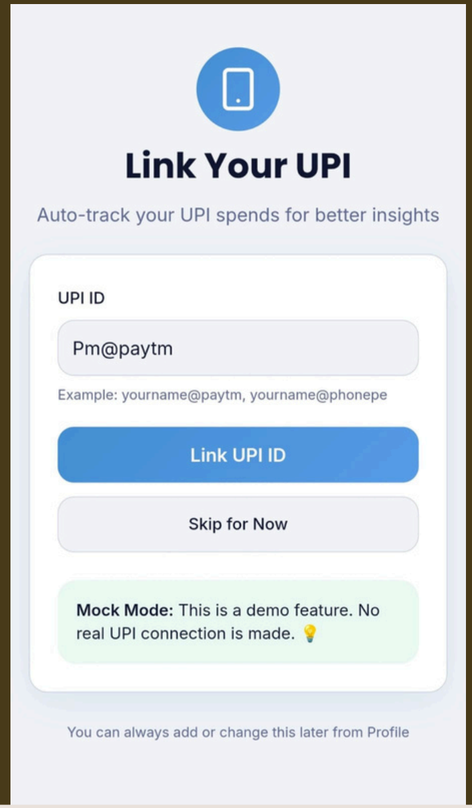
Feature	Impact	Effort	Confidence	Decision
UPI Spend Tracker	5	2	5	MVP
Weekly/Monthly Target Setter	4	2	5	MVP
Nudge & Alert System	4	3	4	MVP
Smart Save Wallet / Reward Goal	5	4	4	MVP
AI Advisory Coach	4	5	2	PHASE 2

Spendwise MVP — From Vision to Reality



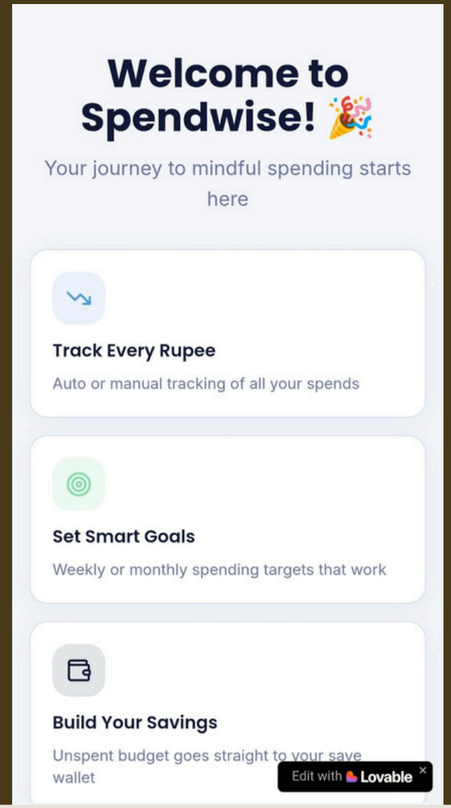
Login / Sign-Up

Users begin by entering their email or phone number to sign up or log in.
A mock OTP verification (accepts any input) ensures a smooth, frictionless onboarding — setting the tone for a secure yet simple experience.



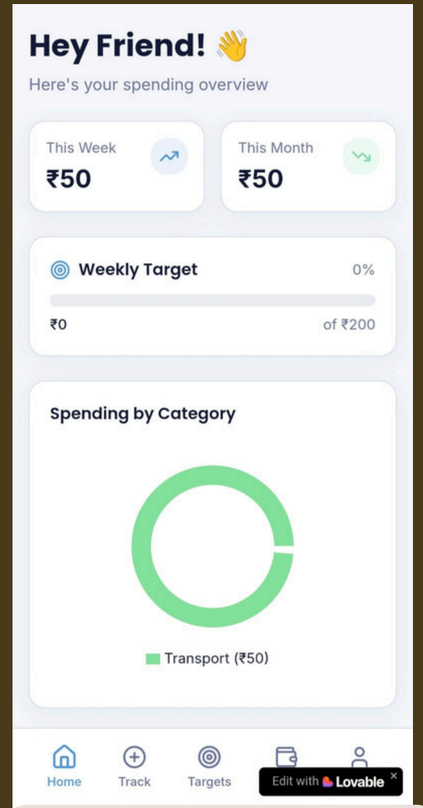
UPI Link or Manual Entry Setup

After onboarding, users can either link their UPI ID (mock link, no API) to auto-track spends or skip and add expenses manually — amount, category, and note.



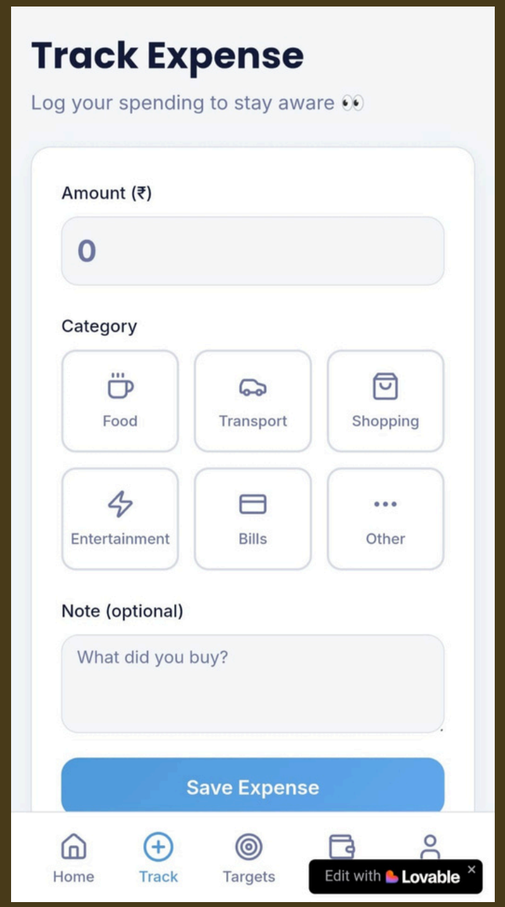
Welcome to Spendwise

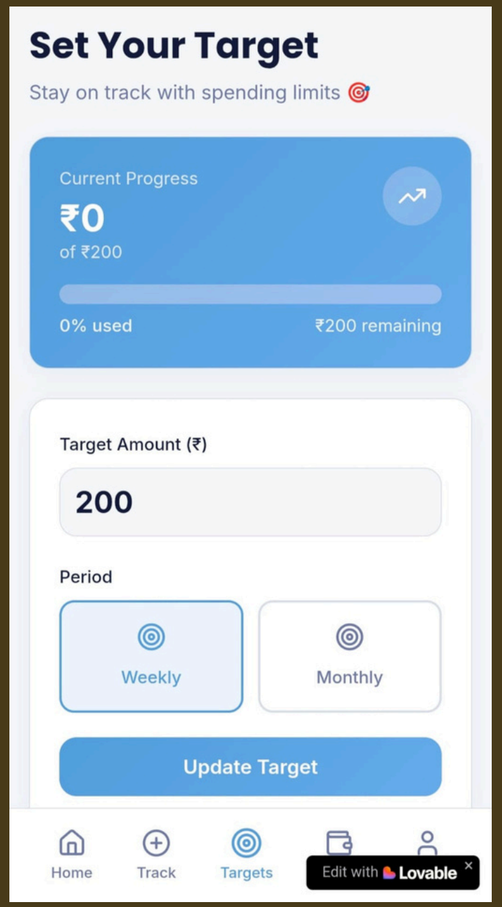
The welcome page greets users with a short, relatable message about building mindful spending habits.
It introduces the app's key features — Track, Set Targets, Save Smartly, and Get Rewarded

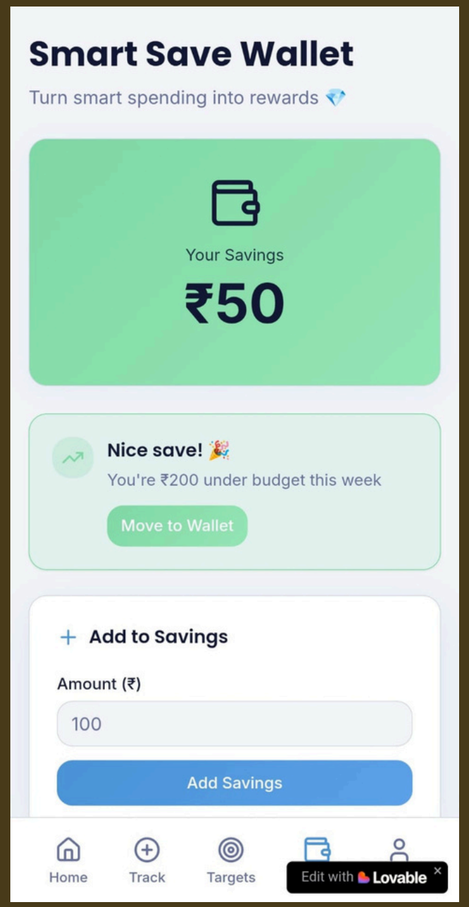


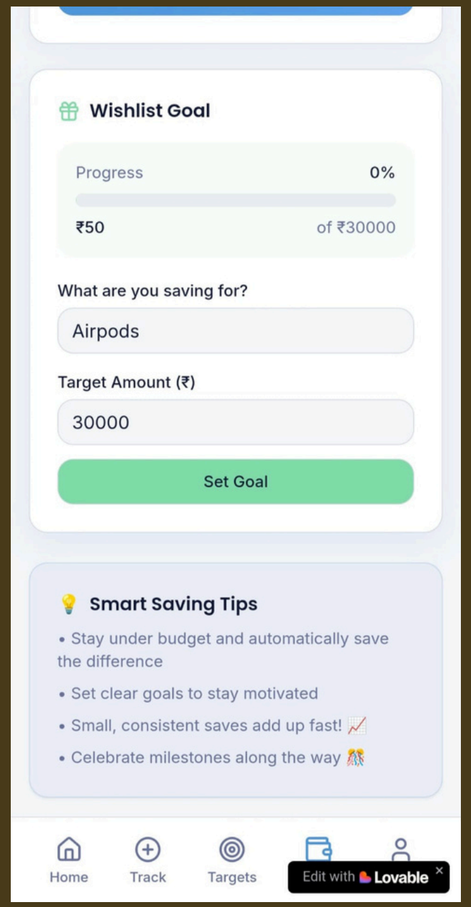
Smart Dashboard

A clean, visual dashboard that breaks down weekly expenses by category — Food, Travel, Bills, Fun, and Others.









PREVIEW LINK

Manual Expense Tracker

Users can manually add any expense — enter the amount, select a category (Food, Travel, Bills, Fun, etc.), and add a short note.

Weekly/Monthly Target Setter

Users can set a weekly or monthly budget limit . A clean progress bar shows how much has been spent and how much remains, with color cues for nearing limits.

Smart Save Wallet & Rewards

Every week, Spendwise auto-calculates what you've saved from your target — or you can add saved amounts manually with a quick note.

Wishlist Goal Tracker

Users can set a wishlist goal — like "Trip to Goa" or "New Phone" — with a target amount.

Spendwise automatically tracks how much you've saved toward that goal

Product Metrics & Growth Loop

North Star Metric (NSM)

Weekly Active Users who track ≥5 transactions on SpendWise.

Why it matters:
Measures both consistent engagement (tracking spends) and core success behavior (spending control).
If this metric grows → users are truly aware, active, and building better habits.

(L1) Metrics

Acquisition	*# of new signups per week*
Activation	*% of users who complete first spend entry + set a weekly goal*
Engagement	*Avg. transactions logged per active user per week*
Retention	*% of users returning weekly*

(L2) Metrics

Avg. dashboard visits / week / user

% users hitting weekly/monthly targets

% users creating & updating wishlist goals

Avg. ₹ saved per user / month

Growth Loop

Awareness:

User tracks spends → sees insights.

Action

Sets targets & monitors weekly progress.

Achievement

Meets goal → saves → celebrates

Advocacy

Shares streak → inspires new users → repeat.

Risks & Mitigation | Next Phase | GTM Strategy

Risks & Mitigation

Risk	Impact	Mitigation Plan
Low User Activation	Few users complete first entry / goal setup	Gamified onboarding + mock UPI data pre-filled
Low Retention	Users stop tracking after 1–2 weeks	Weekly streaks + Smart Save rewards
User Fatigue / Too Much Input	Manual entry feels tedious	Auto-mock UPI sync + quick-add UI
Data Trust & Privacy Concerns	Users hesitate to link UPI IDs	Clear "mock UPI only" messaging + transparent UX

Future Phases

- *AI Spending Coach · Social Save Challenges*
- *Secure UPI API Sync · Bank Insights*
- *Partner Rewards · Smart Finance Advisory*

GTM (Go-to-Market) Strategy

Target Segment:

College students & young professionals (18–23 yrs) in Tier 1 & 2 cities.

💡 Channels:

- Campus ambassador programs & fin-literacy events.
- Influencer collabs on Instagram / YouTube ("Smart Money Challenges").
- Referral rewards for first three weeks of launch.

Growth Levers:

- "No-Spend Day" campaigns → shareable milestones.
- Partner with fin-ed apps or UPI wallets for cross-promotion.
- Community content on LinkedIn & Reddit → build trust & buzz.